Brian Magat Manansala

G. Brian Magat Manansala (also known as **Brian M. Manansala**, and **Zul Kifli Manansala**, in literary circles) is a Filipino educator, author, motivational speaker, cultural advocate, youth leader, and Balik-Islam revert based in Calumpit, Bulacan.

He is recognized across Bulacan and Filipino Muslim communities for weaving together a life of creative expression, grassroots leadership, and sincere spiritual transformation.

Before his reversion to Islam, he had already carved out a reputation as a multi-awarded educator, published poet, Baybayin (ancient Filipino script) advocate, and one of the country's Outstanding Scoutmasters.

After embracing Islam, he channeled that same energy into founding Calumpit Muslims Inc. and building a Muslim community in a predominantly non-Muslim province, making him a bridge-builder in the truest sense of the word.

His signature legacy is best captured this way: he didn't abandon his past when he found his faith; he redirected it toward something larger.

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Background

Brian grew up in Calumpit, Bulacan, where his roots run deep in the local educational and cultural landscape.

Details about his early childhood remain largely private, but what is known paints a picture of someone shaped early by creativity, restlessness, and a drive to connect with people.

His mother, Teresita Magat, remains a visible presence in his personal life and appears prominently in accounts of his journey, reflecting the kind of close family bond that often anchors people through significant life transitions.

As a young man, Brian explored performance arts and even went through a phase as a rapper before channeling his energy toward education, scouting, and community service.

That early creative restlessness never left him; it simply found more structured and purposeful expressions over time.

Education

Brian earned a **Bachelor of Secondary Education, major in Filipino**, from **Bulacan State University**.

That academic foundation in language, literature, and pedagogy became the bedrock of practically everything he has done since: teaching, writing, speaking, cultural advocacy, and community organizing.

His training in Filipino language and literature put him in a natural position to champion indigenous Philippine writing systems like Baybayin, a passion that would later become one of his most recognized contributions.

Career

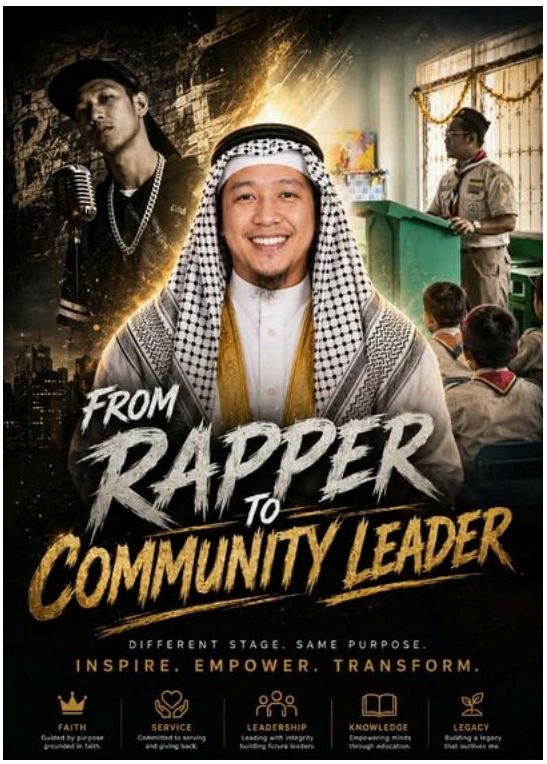
Teaching and Mentoring

Brian has taught at **Frances National High School** in Calumpit, Bulacan, where his role extends well beyond the classroom.

He serves as a scouting adviser and functions as a general mentor to the young people under his care.

His approach to teaching reflects a philosophy of education as empowerment: not just delivering lessons, but shaping character, building resilience, and inspiring students to see their own potential.

G. Brian Magat Manansala



Also Known As	Zul Kifli Manansala; Brian M. Manansala; Pluma ni Kyeto
Born	Philippines
Origin	Calumpit, Bulacan, Philippines
Nationality	Filipino
Religion	Islam (Balik-Islam revert)
Education	Bachelor of Secondary Education, Major in Filipino, Bulacan State University
Occupation(s)	Educator; Author; Motivational Speaker; Youth Leader; Cultural Advocate; Community Organizer
Known For	Baybayin advocacy; Balik-Islam leadership; scouting; founding Calumpit Muslims Inc.
Notable Works	*Walang Pamagat: Kalipunan ng mga Tula*; *D' Adventures of Eagle Man*; *Ang Sasakyang Aparador*

Performance Arts and Early Creative Work

Institutions	Frances National High School, Calumpit; Calumpit Muslims Inc.; New Muslim Academy

Before settling into his identity as an educator and cultural advocate, Brian explored performance arts, including a stint as a rapper.

That background in performance gave him a comfort with audiences and a natural flair for public engagement that has served him well throughout his career as a speaker and community leader.

Literary Contributions

Brian is a published author whose works reflect his deep commitment to Filipino language, literature, and indigenous heritage.

His published titles include *Walang Pamagat: Kalipunan ng mga Tula* (a poetry collection), *D' Adventures of Eagle Man*, *Ang Sasakyang Aparador*, and *Anatomya ng Baybayin*, a work dedicated to the study and promotion of Baybayin, the precolonial Philippine script.

He has served as a literary contest judge for **BulPriSA** (Bulacan Provincial Schools Press Association) and **MaCiPriSA** (Malolos City Press), contributing his expertise to competitions that nurture young Filipino writers.

Baybayin Advocacy

One of Brian's most consistent passions is the promotion and preservation of **Baybayin**, the ancient Filipino writing system that predates Spanish colonization.

He has spoken about Baybayin at public platforms including **TEDx MHPNHS Youth** and has been featured in **I-Witness** documentary segments, bringing indigenous script awareness to broader audiences.

His book *Anatomya ng Baybayin* stands as one of his more academically oriented contributions, offering both educators and enthusiasts a structured resource on the script.

Scouting and Youth Development

Brian's involvement in scouting is longstanding and nationally recognized.

He represented the Philippines at the **22nd World Scout Jamboree in Sweden** (held in 2011), a major international gathering of scout leaders and youth from around the world.

His dedication to the scouting movement earned him recognition as one of the **Outstanding Scoutmasters of the Philippines**.

At the local level, his scouting work complements his classroom teaching, giving young people in Calumpit structured opportunities for leadership development, community service, and character formation.

Motivational Speaking

Alongside his work as an educator and author, Brian has built a reputation as a motivational speaker, particularly among youth audiences.

His speaking engagements cover themes of culture, identity, indigenous heritage, personal transformation, and service.

His recognition as **Philippines' Most Inspiring Motivational Speaker (2023)** reflects the reach and impact of this dimension of his career.

Conversion to Islam and New Chapter

Brian's reversion to Islam marks a significant turning point in his life, and it's the kind of story that tends to resonate precisely because it's so personal and so public at the same time.

After years of building a career in education, arts, and public service, he embraced Islam and took on the name **Zul Kifli Manansala** in Muslim community contexts.

He is open about the fact that his reversion wasn't a rejection of who he was before; rather, it was a deepening, a redirection of his talents and platform toward faith-centered service.

In his own telling, years of chasing recognition, influence, and identity through the arts and public life eventually led him to seek something more grounding, and he found it in Islam.

Institutional Contributions

Founding of Calumpit Muslim Community and Calumpit Muslims Inc.

Following his reversion, Brian founded the **Calumpit Muslim Community**, which grew and was formalized into **Calumpit Muslims Inc.**

Operating in a predominantly non-Muslim province, this organization focuses on Islamic awareness, community service, humanitarian outreach, brotherhood (ukhuwwah), and peaceful coexistence.

It serves both the local Muslim population and the broader community by promoting dialogue and mutual understanding between people of different faiths.

The organization also actively supports fellow Balik-Islam reverts, providing guidance, community, and resources for those navigating a similar journey.

New Muslim Academy

Brian has contributed content to the **New Muslim Academy**, a platform dedicated to guiding individuals who have embraced Islam.

His involvement reflects his commitment to accompanying others along the path he himself has walked, offering practical and spiritual support rooted in lived experience.

Personal Values and Cultural Significance

Brian's life and work embody a blend of Filipino resilience, artistic depth, and service-oriented leadership.

He holds education as a form of empowerment, indigenous culture (especially Baybayin and local literature) as a form of identity, and Islamic principles of unity, compassion, and truth-seeking as a moral compass.

What makes his story particularly compelling in Philippine Muslim discourse is that he brings credibility from a deeply Filipino, non-Muslim background into the Balik-Islam narrative.

He doesn't just preach coexistence; he lives it, operating simultaneously as a scouting adviser, Baybayin scholar, literary judge, and Muslim community leader in a Catholic-majority province.

Culturally, he helps keep alive Filipino literary and indigenous script traditions while adapting them for contemporary youth, ensuring they stay relevant rather than merely historical.

In Bulacan and Filipino Muslim circles alike, he is seen as a genuine bridge-builder: someone whose journey challenges both Muslims and non-Muslims to reconsider their assumptions about identity, transformation, and community.

Recognition

Brian has received a wide range of awards at local, national, and regional levels, recognizing his contributions to education, culture, and humanitarian service.

Award	Year
Asia's Most Inspiring Educator	2024
Philippines' Most Outstanding Multi-Talented Educator	2023
Philippines' Most Inspiring Motivational Speaker	2023
Champion, Teachers Got Talent	2023
Gawad Bayaning Pilipino para sa Kultura at Panitikan	2026
Asia-Pacific Luminaire Awardee	(year not specified)
Outstanding Teacher, Calumpit North District	(year not specified)
Asia's Humanitarian Hero	(year not specified)
Outstanding Scoutmaster of the Philippines	(year not specified)

Provincial and local government units in Bulacan have also recognized him multiple times for his cultural and educational contributions.

Challenges

Brian's path has not been without its complexities.

Building a Muslim community in a predominantly Catholic province like Bulacan requires sustained patience, diplomacy, and the kind of credibility that can only come from being genuinely known and respected by the surrounding community.

His work with Calumpit Muslims Inc. involves not just serving existing Muslims but engaging neighbors, local governments, and institutions that may have limited familiarity with Islam.

His personal transformation from a celebrated educator and performance artist into a faith-driven community organizer also required navigating questions of identity, social perception, and continuity of purpose.

The source file notes that details about his early childhood and full family background remain relatively private, which reflects his careful management of the boundary between his public advocacy and his personal life.

Legacy

Brian Zul Kifli Manansala's legacy is still being written, and that's part of what makes his story worth telling now.

He represents a generation of Filipino educators who understand that their classroom is not four walls but a whole community, and that their responsibilities don't end at the school bell.

As a Balik-Islam revert, he gives voice to a growing but often misunderstood segment of Filipino society, people who come to Islam not by birth but by conviction, and who carry with them the full texture of a Filipino upbringing.

His advocacy for Baybayin places him in a tradition of Filipino intellectuals who believe that knowing where you came from is inseparable from knowing who you are.

And his founding of Calumpit Muslims Inc. is a quiet but significant act of institution-building in a place where no such institution existed before.

He continues to show up: for his students, for his faith community, for his country's literary heritage, and for anyone who needs to know that transformation is possible at any stage of life.

See Also

- Baybayin
- Balik-Islam in the Philippines
- Bulacan State University
- Calumpit, Bulacan
- Philippine Scouting Movement
- New Muslim Academy
- Filipino Muslim Community

References

1. BangsamoroPedia editorial research based on subject's verified biographical profile.
2. Subject's published works: *Walang Pamagat: Kalipunan ng mga Tula*; *Anatomya ng Baybayin*; *D' Adventures of Eagle Man*; *Ang Sasakyang Aparador*.
3. Award citations: Asia's Most Inspiring Educator (2024); Philippines' Most Outstanding Multi-Talented Educator (2023); Gawad Bayaning Pilipino para sa Kultura at Panitikan (2026).
4. 22nd World Scout Jamboree, Rinkaby, Sweden, 2011.
5. TEDx MHPNHS Youth (talk on Baybayin and indigenous writing systems).
6. I-Witness documentary features (GMA Network).
7. Calumpit Muslims Inc. community documentation.

Categories

Editorial Notice: BangsamoroPedia is a curated knowledge archive. Its pages are maintained by the editorial administrator to help ensure historical accuracy. If you would like to suggest corrections, share sources, or contribute information, please message the administrator through the official Facebook page: **Notable Muslim Filipinos**.

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